



THAROOR HAS ALLEGED THAT MODI (LEFT) IS TRYING TO DISCREDIT RENDEZVOUS AND BAT FOR ANOTHER TEAM

starters, there's Modi's brother-in-law Suresh Chellaram (his wife Minal's sister's husband) who is co-owner—and majority stakeholder—in Rajasthan Royals. This year, there's been another relative value addition: Modi's stepson-in-law Gaurav Burman. Burman's Elephant Capital picked up a 50 per cent stake in Global Cricket Ventures (GCV), which happens to be the IPL's exclusive worldwide online and mobile broadcast licensee, official website partner, as well as, through its acquisition, Willow TV, official TV and online broadcast rights holder for North America. Gaurav's elder brother Mohit, is also happily co-owner of a 24.5 per cent stake in Kings XI Punjab as well as Gaurav's partner in Elephant Capital.

It has never bothered Modi so far and indeed Kunal Dasgupta, former Sony CEO who negotiated a \$1 billion broadcast rights deal with Modi in Season 1, says he sees nothing wrong in this set-up. "Modi could only have turned to the people he knew when he wanted to start the IPL from the ground up. Who knew what it would

become?" At the moment, it has become a battlefield. Modi's Rajasthan bete noire, the Rajasthan Cricket Association secretary Sanjay Dixit, did to Modi on Twitter just what Modi did to Tharoor. Dixit, an IAS officer raided by the CBI over accusations for recommending a passport for a criminal, asked beseechingly, "Lalit, please also disclose the details of the shareholdings of your relatives in Jaipur IPL and GCV Mauritius." At the time of going to press, Lalit was setting his new Twitter record: Cyberspace silence after 6.54 a.m. on April 12.

Tharoor has opened a new front, saying that the IPL implosion had taken place because Modi was trying to discredit Rendezvous and bat for another team. The other team could be one of those who lost out on the March 21 bid: Adani Enterprises, VC Digital (Videon) and Amman Vohra (a Pune-based consortium headed by magnate Cyrus Poonawalla). There is a theory that by arm-twisting Kochi, Modi is merely acting on behalf of a politician who was grumpy because his prized selection

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